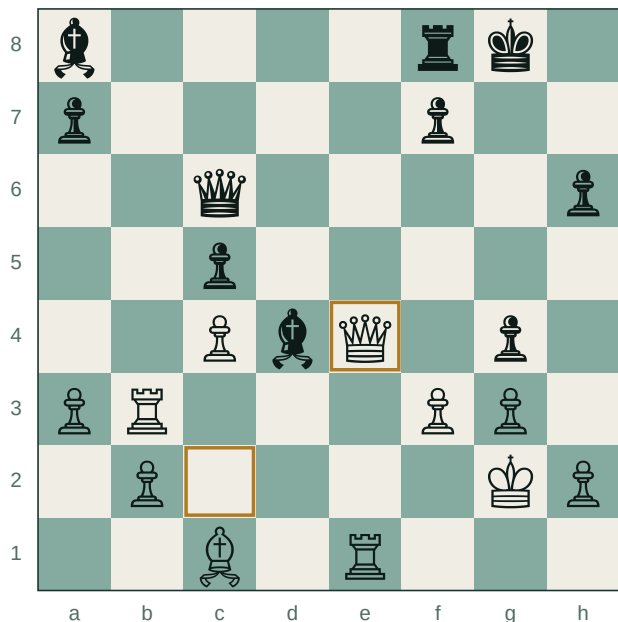


Pins and pressure: Black, move 31

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Qe4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...gxf3+ 32. Rxf3 Qxe4 33. Rxe4 Bxe4

31...gxf3+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on f3. Recorded reply: **32.Rxf3**.

32...Qxe4 The queen captures the queen on e4. From e4 it attacks rook on f3 and rook on e1. Recorded reply: **33.Rxe4**.

33...Bxe4 The bishop captures the rook on e4.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g2. Geometrically undefended: rook on b3. Check for tactical protection.